

Action Plan for Nord University's Strategy for Internationalization (Spring 2026 – Fall 2028)

Note: All actions connect with Nord University's Strategy for Internationalization and Strategy 2030

Action	Short Description	Responsible	Start	End	Evaluation / KPIs	Connects with:
Visibility and Profile						
Global Branding Campaign	Develop and launch a global branding campaign, including branding packages for use by researchers and faculties to raise Nord's visibility and advance recruitment. The global branding campaign is embedded within the wider Nord actions for communications, marketing, and recruitment.	Main responsibility: Nord Communications Team Contributing responsibility: International Office, Faculties	S26	F27	10-15% increase of international students arriving at Nord by F27 Increase of 20% visitors from outside Norway to study programme pages in English + Admissions page (tracked through Siteimprove)	Communication Strategy for Nord University 2024-2030
International network mapping	Systematic and visible (internal and external) mapping of international networks to enhance Nord's engagement with institutions and alliances (SEA-EU, FOREU4All, etc), maintain mapping tracker	Main responsibility: International Office Contributing responsibility: Research Office, Faculties, IT	S26	S27	Creation of network/ stakeholder mapping tracker; engagement with alliances	
Research						
Horizon Europe Applications	Identify core clusters for HEU applications bootcamps, support teams, consortia development and proposal fast-track. Commence programme for acceleration, involving bootcamps, additional guest advisors, additional proposal fast-track support.	Main responsibility: Pro-Rector Research, and Research Office Contributing responsibility: Faculties, Pro Deans Research, Research Group Leaders	S26	F28	Expand by delivering 10-15 more HEU applications each year	Horizon Europe Strategic Plan 2025-2027
HR Excellence in Research	Implement European Charter & Code for Researchers, improve 4-6 principles, and achieve/renew HR Excellence award.	Main responsibility: HR Contributing responsibility: Research Office	S26	F27	Charter & Code endorsed; HR Excellence renewed	HR Excellence in Research

Expand COST Network ¹ participation	Increase involvement in COST networks, develop and support new proposals through targeted action.	Main responsibility: Research Office Contributing responsibility: Faculties	S26	F28	≥ 5 new researchers involved in WG and management committees per year	COST Strategy
SEA-EU Virtual Research Administration	Establish a virtual platform to streamline SEA-EU research collaboration.	Main responsibility: Research Office Contributing responsibility: IT	S26	F27	Functional platform launched; ≥10 joint SEA-EU proposals in various areas over the period	SEA-EU Mission Statement
Horizon Europe Pillar 2 support	Strengthen institutional capacity to coordinate Pillar 2 projects.	Main responsibility: Pro-Rector Research and Research Office Contributing responsibility: Faculties, Pro Deans Research, Research Administration, Research Group Leaders	S26	F28	≥5 coordinated Pillar 2 proposals over the period; ≥25% success rate	Horizon Europe Work Programme
MSCA Doctoral Networks and MSCA European and Global Postdoctoral Fellowships	Increase submissions and coordination of MSCA DN proposals. Increase submissions of MSCA European and Global Postdoctoral Fellowship proposals.	Main responsibility: Research Office Contributing responsibility: Faculties	S26	F28	≥3 MSCA DN submissions/year and 18 MSCA PF applications/year; ≥ 3 coordinated project/year; ≥12 PhD and postdoc candidates recruited/year	Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions
Education						
Virtual Exchange Pilot	Pilot virtual exchange in selected study programmes across all faculties	Main responsibility: Pro-Rector Education Contributing responsibility: Pro-Deans Education, Course coordinators of relevant programmes	S26	F27	Positive student feedback (≥80% satisfaction) ; further developments of virtual exchange based on experience gained in pilot	

¹ The EU Cost Actions provide networking opportunities for researchers and practitioners in all fields of science and technology. Each COST Action lasts for 4 years and offers a wide range of small-scale funding opportunities and networking events (e.g. training schools, short-term scientific missions, conferences). While there is a yearly deadline to submit new COST Action proposals, it is also possible to join ongoing COST Actions, for example as a Management Committee member or a Working Group member. COST Action participants consistently report many benefits, including scientific ones such as joint publications and invitations to grant proposals.

English-medium course consolidation and expansion	Ensure an offer of ≥30 ECTS in English per faculty per semester at bachelor and master's level and look for scope to expand this.	Main responsibility: Pro-Rector Education Contributing responsibility: Pro-Deans Education, Course coordinators	S26	F27	Track course availability and student nominations	
Internationalisation staff development	Develop an online module of short courses on internationalisation and intercultural competence.	Main responsibility: PLUS Contributing responsibility: International Office, IT as needed for online element	S27	F28	≥70% staff trained; course satisfaction survey	
Erasmus+ KA2 collaboration capacity	Establish support system for proposal development and post-grant management.	Main responsibility: International Office Contributing responsibility: Faculties	F26	F28	≥15-20 KA2 proposals (partner or coordinator) submitted/year; ≥6-8 projects (partner or coordinator)/year	Key Action 2: Cooperation amongst organisations and institutions
Mobility Windows in study programmes ²	Ensuring functional mobility windows in study programmes that are sustainable and as active as possible.	Responsible for tracking progress: International Committee Responsible for mobility window: All faculties	S26	F28	20-30% increase in number of students going on exchange 80-100% satisfaction with mobility experience	
Mobility and Recruitment						
Student Mobility Accelerator	Optimise workflows and processes for mobility, including double and joint degree programmes.	Main responsibility: International Office Contributing responsibility: Admissions, Faculties	S26	F28	Increase outbound mobility 2% ➔ 5-10%	

2 Ensuring Functional Mobility Windows in Study Programmes

Based on: § 2-2 (8) Studietilbud som fører fram til en grad, skal ha ordninger for internasjonal studentutveksling. Innholdet i utvekslingen skal være faglig relevant. While most study programmes formally include a mobility window, in accordance to the accreditation process, it can be challenging for students to find equivalent and academically relevant courses abroad. This limits both outgoing mobility and the university's internationalisation goals. To ensure that the mobility windows across our programmes are functional, the following is proposed:

1. Mobility in the programme design – (re)-accreditation

- Design the "mobility" semester, typically 5th or 6th semester (bachelor programmes), as flexible as possible, with elective courses. If possible, establish a "international semester" module equivalent to 30 ECTS. This module can be defined by competencies or learning outcomes instead of specific

courses

2. Mobility clusters

- In programmes where students must have a specific set of skills/courses, identify two to three strategic partners with matching curriculum. A course list can be developed and/or pre-approved to ensure recognition. Communication between the SPA, studieveileder and International Coordinator at the faculties is important for this step

3. Outcome-based recognition

- Courses should be recognised as equivalent, when necessary, based on the learning outcomes and not solely on the title of the course. This will make the mobility more feasible without compromising academic quality or skills uptake.

Global Recruitment Strategy	Systematic recruitment plan for international staff/students, linked to branding campaign; structured onboarding and welcome programme for international staff and students.	Main responsibility: Communications Contributing responsibility: International Office, Faculties, HR	S26	F28	+10-15% international enrolment; ≥80% retention of international staff	Communication Strategy for Nord University 2024-2030
Professional Staff Mobility	Support and strengthen international exchange and training for administrative/technical staff contributing to research and education, with a focus on existing collaborations.	Main responsibility: International Office	S27	F28	+ 10-20% increase in number of staff participating	
International Career Platform	Launch AFU-based career platform showcasing research career opportunities.	Main responsibility: Research Office Contributing responsibility: IT	F26	F27	Platform launched; ≥500 visits/month	

Strategic Partnerships & Collaboration

Global Benchmarking & Rankings	Benchmark Nord against peer universities globally, consider rankings, and address gaps.	Main responsibility: Rectorate	S27	F27	Benchmark report delivered; improvement plan adopted	Relevant ranking systems, such as: THE Rankings QS World University Rankings
SEA-EU Alliance 3.0	Actively contribute to the SEA-EU 3.0 application and strengthen Nord's role in the Alliance governance, longevity and joint projects.	Main responsibility: Rectorate Contributing responsibility: International Office, Faculties	F25	F28	SEA-EU 3.0 application submitted S26; accepted S27; ≥250 staff/student SEA-EU engagements/year	SEA-EU Mission Statement
Arctic Six Initiative	Lead/co-lead joint projects, produce Arctic Six roadmap, and promote participation across faculties.	Main responsibility: Rectorate Contributing responsibility: Research Office, Education Office, Faculties	S26	F28	≥3 joint Arctic Six projects; ≥150 staff/student Arctic Six engagements/year by F28	Arctic Six Bylaws

UArctic Engagement	Promote and increase participation in UArctic thematic networks and projects.	Main responsibility: Rectorate Contributing responsibility: International Office, Research Office	S26	F28	≥3-5 UArctic-affiliated projects	UArctic Strategic Plan 2030
Strategic Network Prioritization	Identify and fund priority international networks for both research and education	Main responsibility: Rectorate Contributing responsibility: Research Office	S27	F28	Funding applications submitted to ≥3 networks	